CheckIn Competitive Analysis

Market Landscape, Direct Competitors & Strategic Positioning

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Executive Summary

This analysis examines every company that could compete with CheckIn across three categories: African identity verification providers, global no-code verification platforms, and vertical-specific screening solutions (hospitality, tenant screening, background checks).

The key finding: nobody is doing exactly what CheckIn proposes. The market has API-first KYC companies selling to fintechs, global no-code platforms with no African ID coverage, and vertical screening tools that only operate in the US and Europe. CheckIn occupies an open strategic position at the intersection of no-code self-serve UX, African government ID infrastructure, non-fintech operator targeting, and consumer identity (Vouch). No competitor has all four.

The closest threats are YouVerify's Compliance Workflow Builder and Premably's IdentityForms, both of which offer no-code flow builders with shareable links. However, both are positioned for compliance teams at fintechs and enterprises, not for operations staff at hotels, logistics companies, and car rentals. Repositioning for that market would require them to rethink their pricing, UX, positioning, and go-to-market — a significant pivot that risks cannibalizing their core business.

Category 1: African Identity Verification Providers

These are Dojah's direct competitors in the African KYC market. All are API-first and primarily serve fintechs, banks, and enterprises with developer teams.

YouVerify

Headquarters: Lagos, Nigeria

Founded: 2017

Target customers: Banks, fintechs, lending platforms, insurance companies

Coverage: 200+ countries, deep coverage in Nigeria and Ghana

Key products: YouVerify Operating System (yvOS), Compliance Workflow Builder, identity verification, address verification, AML screening, KYB

What makes them relevant: YouVerify is the most direct competitive threat because they already have a no-code drag-and-drop Compliance Workflow Builder. This tool allows businesses to build step-by-step verification flows, set automatic verification requests, and automate decision-making with preset rules and actions. They also offer customizable forms that can be shared via links.

YouVerify's Workflow Builder vs. CheckIn

Dimension	YouVerify Workflow Builder	CheckIn
Target user	Compliance officers at fintechs/banks	Operations staff at hotels, logistics, car rentals
Positioning	KYC/AML compliance automation	No-code identity verification for any operator
Language/UX	Compliance terminology (KYC, AML, CDD)	Plain language (verify guests, screen riders)
Pricing	Enterprise pricing, minimum commitments	Pay-per-check from ₦500, tenant-pays model
Distribution	Sales-led, enterprise demos	Self-serve signup, QR codes, shareable links
Consumer layer	None	Vouch integration — reusable verified identity
Fraud intelligence	Basic AML screening	ProfiledRisk trust scores in every report
Ecosystem	Standalone product	Feeds Dojah API, Vouch, ProfiledRisk, MyPass

Competitive risk: Medium-High. YouVerify has the closest feature set. If they decided to pursue the non-fintech SMB market with their workflow builder, they could be a credible competitor. However, their entire brand, pricing, and sales motion is built around compliance — pivoting to serve hotel front desks and logistics companies would require a fundamental repositioning.

Defensibility: CheckIn's advantages are the Vouch consumer identity layer (no equivalent at YouVerify), ProfiledRisk fraud scores, the tenant-pays pricing model, and the ecosystem flywheel. YouVerify sells a tool; CheckIn is an entry point to a network.

Smile ID

Headquarters: Lagos, Nigeria (with offices in Cape Town and Nairobi)

Founded: 2017

Funding: Strategic partnership with Mastercard; backed by Costanoa Ventures, CRE Venture Capital

Target customers: Fintechs, banks, telecoms, mobility platforms

Coverage: Every African country; 99.8% facial recognition accuracy across all skin tones

Key products: Biometric KYC, document verification, AML screening, SmartSelfie authentication

What makes them relevant: Smile ID is the largest African identity verification company by partnership scale (Mastercard, Flutterwave). They have the deepest biometric capabilities on the continent. However, they are purely API/SDK — no no-code product, no self-serve flow builder, no shareable verification links.

Competitive risk: Low for CheckIn specifically. Smile ID competes with Dojah's core API product, not with CheckIn. They could build a no-code layer, but it's not in their current roadmap or positioning. They're moving deeper into enterprise biometrics, not broader into SMB self-serve.

Prembly (Identitypass)

Headquarters: Lagos, Nigeria

Founded: 2021

Funding: Y Combinator W22

Target customers: Fintechs, banks, HR platforms, lending companies

Coverage: Nigeria, Kenya, Ghana, South Africa, Uganda + expanding into Asia

Key products: IdentityPass (KYC APIs), IdentityRadar (fraud monitoring), IdentityForms (form builder with verification), BGC (background checks)

What makes them relevant: Prembly has IdentityForms — a form builder with built-in identity verification that can be shared via QR code, SMS, and WhatsApp. They also recently added background checks (criminal, education, employment) across 30+ countries. This is conceptually close to what CheckIn offers.

Prembly IdentityForms vs. CheckIn

Dimension	Prembly IdentityForms	CheckIn
Product maturity	Feature within larger platform	Standalone product with dedicated UX

Target user	Compliance/HR teams at fintechs	Non-technical operators (hotels, logistics)
Flow builder	Basic form builder with verification endpoints	Purpose-built drag-and-drop with segment templates
Operator dashboard	Generic verification dashboard	Dedicated pipeline view (pending/pass/fail)
Pricing model	API-style per-call pricing	Tiered: pay-per-check, subscription, tenant-pays
Consumer identity	None	Vouch integration for reusable credentials
Background checks	Criminal, education, employment (30+ countries)	Trust score via ProfiledRisk + verification
Distribution	Developer-focused, API docs	Self-serve, QR codes at physical locations

Competitive risk: Medium. IdentityForms has similar mechanics (shareable forms + verification) but it's a small feature within Prembly's larger compliance platform, not a standalone product. Their background check capability across 30+ countries is a genuine strength that CheckIn would need to match over time.

Defensibility: CheckIn wins on UX specificity (built for operators, not compliance teams), pricing innovation (tenant-pays model), and the Vouch ecosystem. Prembly would need to build a dedicated product team focused on non-fintech SMBs to compete effectively.

Identify Africa

Headquarters: Nigeria

Founded: 2024

Target customers: Fintechs, businesses needing KYC compliance

Coverage: 20+ government ID databases

Key products: No-code APIs for identity verification, AML, document verification

What makes them relevant: New entrant positioning around "no-code APIs." However, "no-code APIs" is a contradiction — APIs by definition require integration. Their "no-code" claim refers to simplified API integration, not a self-serve flow builder for non-technical operators.

Competitive risk: Low. Early-stage, small team, no differentiated product beyond what Dojah, YouVerify, and Prembly already offer. Not a threat to CheckIn specifically.

Category 2: Global No-Code Verification Platforms

These companies offer no-code or low-code verification products globally but have limited or no African ID coverage and price points designed for Western markets.

Onfido / Entrust (Workflow Studio + Smart Capture Link)

Headquarters: London, UK (acquired by Entrust in 2024)

What they offer: Workflow Studio is a visual orchestration tool for building identity verification flows. Smart Capture Link is a hosted, no-code frontend that generates a shareable verification link — very similar to CheckIn's core mechanic.

Coverage: 2,500+ document types globally, limited African government ID database lookups

Pricing: Enterprise-only, minimum annual commitments

Competitive risk: Low for African markets. Strong product but priced for Western enterprises. No NIN, BVN, or Ghana Card database integration. Would need significant localization to compete in Africa.

Sumsub

Headquarters: London, UK

What they offer: No-code workflow builder for identity verification with global coverage. Orchestrates document checks, biometrics, AML screening, and liveness detection without code.

Coverage: Global, including some African countries for document verification

Pricing: Enterprise pricing, not suitable for African SMB economics

Competitive risk: Low. Global platform with no specific African ID database integration or SMB pricing. Competes with Dojah's API at the enterprise level, not with CheckIn at the SMB level.

Didit

Headquarters: Spain

What they offer: Visual node-based workflow editor for identity verification with hosted shareable links and multiple integration options (SDK, iframe, API). Offers migration from Sumsub, Veriff, Persona, and Onfido.

Coverage: Global, Western-focused

Pricing: Competitive against incumbents but still designed for tech companies

Competitive risk: Low for Africa. Most conceptually similar to CheckIn's approach (no-code + shareable links) but zero African ID coverage. Would need to build Dojah's entire verification infrastructure from scratch to compete in Africa.

uqudo

Headquarters: Dubai, UAE

What they offer: Identity platform for Middle East and Africa with no-code KYC option that launches via unique URL or QR code. Has pre-built templates for hospitality, including hotel guest verification workflows.

Coverage: MEA region, including South Africa; lighter coverage in West Africa

Pricing: Enterprise-focused

Competitive risk: Medium for South Africa specifically; Low for West Africa. uqudo is the closest global competitor in terms of geographic overlap and product concept. Their hospitality templates are directly relevant. However, their West African coverage is limited (no deep NIN/BVN integration), and they target large hotel chains and enterprises, not SMB operators.

Category 3: Vertical-Specific Screening Solutions

Hospitality Guest Screening (US/Europe Only)

There is a mature market for vacation rental and hotel guest screening in the US and Europe. These products validate the demand for CheckIn's hotel segment but none operate in Africa.

Company	What They Do	Geography	Relevance to CheckIn
Autohost	AI-powered guest screening with customizable verification packages, background checks, liveness detection	US, Canada, Europe	Validates demand. Most feature-rich. No Africa.
ChargeAutomation	Guest screening with ID verification and biometric matching for short-term rentals	US, Europe	Web-based (no app download). Similar UX concept.
Authenticate	Guest verification with criminal checks, watchlist screening, customizable flows	US, Europe	Customizable screening similar to CheckIn's flow builder.
Truvi	Guest screening against 2,400+ US criminal databases	US only	US-only. Deep criminal checks. Not applicable to Africa.
Safely	Short-term rental guest screening with insurance bundling	US	Interesting model: verification + insurance. Could inspire CheckIn add-on.

Key insight: The hospitality screening market is proven and growing in the US/Europe. These companies charge $5–15 per guest check. Nobody has brought this to Africa. CheckIn can be the Autohost of Africa — adapted for local ID infrastructure and SMB price points.

Tenant Screening (US Only)

The US tenant screening market is large and well-established. These platforms validate CheckIn's property management use case.

Company	Model	Cost	Key Feature
SmartMove (TransUnion)	Credit report + criminal + eviction	$25–40/check	ResidentScore designed for rental risk
TurboTenant	Self-serve landlord platform with screening	$45–55 (tenant pays)	Tenant-pays model (same as CheckIn)
Zillow Rental Manager	Screening embedded in listings	$35 (renter pays)	Renter-pays, integrated into listing flow
Baselane	360° screening with ID + selfie verification	$35–45/check	Government ID + selfie match (like CheckIn)

RentPrep	FCRA-compliant screening with manual review	$29–55/check	Human review of results
TenantCloud	All-in-one landlord platform with screening	Varies	Full property management + screening

Key insight: TurboTenant and Zillow both use the tenant-pays model where the renter covers the screening cost — exactly what CheckIn proposes. This model is proven at scale in the US. Nobody has brought it to Africa. Baselane's approach of combining government ID verification with selfie matching is closest to CheckIn's verification flow.

Nigerian Background Check Companies (Traditional/Manual)

These are established Nigerian firms doing background checks manually. They validate the demand but operate with a fundamentally different model.

Company	Founded	Services	Model	Limitation
BCI (Background Check International)	2004	Employment, education, criminal, tenant, guarantor checks	Manual, report-based	Slow (days/weeks), expensive, no self-serve
360 Verify	2014	Criminal, address, guarantor, property, tenancy checks	Manual + some digital	Enterprise-focused, no SMB self-serve
Risk Control Nigeria	~2008	Pre-employment, tenant vetting, 5M+ education records	Manual with proprietary database	Manual process, no real-time verification
VerifyMe Nigeria	2013	KYC, KYB, digital verification (Pluto, QoreID brands)	API + dashboard	Tech-focused, not targeting non-tech operators

Key insight: Traditional background check companies charge ₦10,000–50,000+ per check and take days to deliver results. CheckIn offers instant results at ₦1,500–2,000. The price and speed differential is massive — CheckIn doesn't just compete with these companies, it makes them obsolete for most use cases.

Feature Comparison Matrix

How CheckIn compares across the dimensions that matter for non-technical African operators:

Capability	CheckIn	YouVerify	Prembly	Smile ID	Onfido	Autohost
No-code flow builder	✓	✓	Partial	✗	✓	✗
Shareable links / QR codes	✓	✗	✓	✗	✓	✗
African govt ID (NIN, BVN, Ghana Card)	✓	✓	✓	✓	✗	✗
SMB self-serve pricing	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	Partial
Tenant/person-pays model	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗
Consumer identity layer (Vouch)	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗
Fraud/trust scoring	✓	Partial	✓	Partial	✓	✓
Non-fintech operator targeting	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	✓
Multi-product ecosystem	✓	Partial	Partial	✗	✗	✗
Operates in Africa	✓	✓	✓	✓	✗	✗

CheckIn's Strategic Position

The Gap in the Market

The competitive landscape reveals a clear gap:

- African KYC providers (YouVerify, Prembly, Smile ID) have the verification infrastructure but are locked into serving fintechs and enterprises through developer-facing tools
- Global no-code platforms (Onfido, Sumsub, Didit) have the self-serve UX but lack African ID coverage and SMB-friendly pricing
- Vertical screening solutions (Autohost, TurboTenant, SmartMove) have proven the demand for operator-facing verification in hospitality and property but only operate in the US and Europe
- Nigerian background check companies (BCI, 360 Verify) serve the market manually at 10–50x the price and days/weeks slower

CheckIn sits at the intersection of all four: African ID infrastructure + no-code self-serve + vertical operator targeting + consumer identity layer. Nobody else occupies this position.

Moat Analysis

1. Infrastructure moat: Dojah's existing verification APIs across Nigeria, Ghana, Kenya, and South Africa. A new entrant would need 3–5 years to build equivalent coverage and government data source relationships.

2. Network moat (Vouch): Every CheckIn verification seeds a reusable Vouch identity. As Vouch adoption grows, returning verifications become instant and near-free. Competitors would need to build their own consumer identity network from zero.

3. Data moat (ProfiledRisk): Every verification enriches fraud intelligence. More data means better trust scores, which makes CheckIn more valuable for operators. This compounds with volume.

4. Distribution moat: QR codes at hotel desks, CheckIn links in job listings, tenant-pays viral loops — the product distributes itself through physical presence. Difficult for API-first competitors to replicate.

5. Pricing moat: The tenant-pays model means operators adopt at zero cost. Competitors charging operators directly face a structural disadvantage in acquisition.

Competitive Threats to Monitor

Threat	Likelihood	Impact	Response
YouVerify launches a dedicated SMB product	Medium	High	Move fast. First-mover advantage in SMB mindshare is hard to displace. Build operator relationships and case studies before they pivot.

Prembly expands IdentityForms into a standalone product	Medium	Medium	Differentiate on Vouch integration, tenant-pays model, and segment-specific UX. Prembly's strength is background checks — consider partnership or building equivalent.
Smile ID adds no-code product	Low	High	Unlikely in near term (focused on enterprise biometrics). If they do, their brand recognition would be a threat. Speed matters.
Global player (Onfido/Sumsub) enters African SMB market	Low	Medium	Would require significant localization (pricing, ID types, local partners). By the time they do, CheckIn should have 1,000+ operators.
New African startup copies CheckIn model	Medium	Low	Execution speed and ecosystem effects (Vouch, ProfiledRisk, Dojah API) create barriers that a standalone copycat can't match.

Conclusion

The identity verification market in Africa is crowded at the API layer but empty at the operator-facing self-serve layer. Every competitor is chasing the same customer — fintechs with dev teams. CheckIn targets a different customer entirely: the 95%+ of businesses that need to verify people but don't have developers.

The proven demand for no-code verification (YouVerify Workflow Builder, Onfido Smart Capture Link, Prembly IdentityForms) and for vertical-specific screening (Autohost, TurboTenant, SmartMove) confirms that the market exists. The absence of anyone combining both approaches for the African market confirms that the opportunity is open.

The window won't stay open forever. YouVerify and Prembly both have the technical capability to build a CheckIn-like product. Speed to market and depth of operator relationships will determine who wins this category. CheckIn's structural advantages — the Vouch consumer layer, ProfiledRisk data, tenant-pays pricing, and the Dojah ecosystem flywheel — are difficult to replicate but only matter if the product ships and gains traction before competitors notice the opportunity.